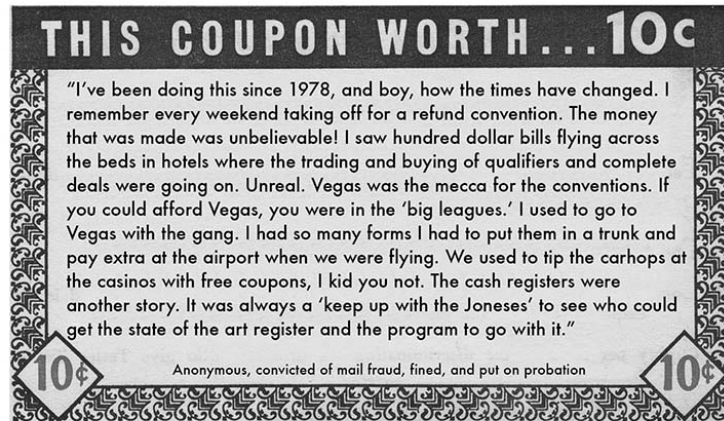


average for rejections, equivalent to 767 percent of the deliverable addresses.



For someone like me who had never attended a refund convention, their subsequent demise was of little consequence. But even the most isolated refunder would hear about Ellen Biles, a Norcross, Georgia, woman indicted for rebate fraud. Biles was arrested at a March 19, 1993, refund convention she was hosting. Authorities began investigating Ms. Biles after a Pep Boys automotive center in Norcross received an anonymous letter accusing Biles of creating false Pep Boys receipts and selling them along with \$5 rebate claims on tires. Store managers had received fifty-five claims from across the country for tires supposedly bought at the Norcross store. Most of the receipts were dated October 28, 1992. Evidence submitted at her trial revealed that Biles had received in excess of seven hundred thousand dollars from her fraudulent rebate business between December 1990 and March of 1993. Besides renting out post office boxes under alias names, she taught others how to use her questionable methods to wealth in a monthly bulletin called, "Ellen and Tony's Catalog."